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BOAT COVER

Abstract

A boat cover that is configured to be deployed over the top of a boat so as to provide protection from items such as but not limited to dust, debris and sunlight. The body of the present invention is manufactured from a fabric blend wherein the fabric blend has a stretch percentage of five hundred to eight hundred percent. The stretch percentage of the body is utilized in conjunction with an elastic cord sewn into the perimeter of the body to provide a force tension across the body subsequent installation thereof sufficient to maintain the body in position. The body further includes a plurality of tie-down straps employed to provide additional securing of the body to the boat. In a preferred embodiment of the present invention that body is manufactured from one of the following fabric blends: polyester/elastane blend, nylon/elastane blend and bamboo/elastane blend.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

[0001] The present invention relates generally to protective equipment, more specifically but not by way of limitation, a universal boat cover that is configured to provide protection of a boat from dust, debris and UV exposure wherein the present invention is manufactured from a lightweight high stretch material so as to facilitate improved deployment and storage thereof.

BACKGROUND

[0002] In North America there are approximately thirteen million registered boats for recreational use. Millions of boat owners utilize their boats for a variety of water activities such as but not limited to skiing, fishing and cruising. There are numerous types of marine vessels that range in size from as small as twelve feet to hundreds of feet in length. Smaller trailerable boats are quite common and these boats typically range in size from around eighteen to twenty six feet in length. Common boat types in this size range are boats such as but not limited to ski boats, dual consoles and pontoon boats.

[0003] The cost of a common ski boat can easily exceed over one hundred thousand dollars and costs for pontoon style boats can also reach well over fifty thousand dollars. Some of the boat manufacturers provide with the purchase of a boat a canvas material cover that is utilized to protect the boat when stored as well as during trailering the boat. These canvas style covers are quite large and can easily weigh twenty to thirty pounds. The size and weight of these canvas material boat covers will often lead to the boat owners not utilizing them as the storage, deployment and removal is to cumbersome and time consuming. The interior of boats often include very expensive electronics as well as upholstery which can be damage when expose to elements such as but not limited to UV light from the sun and dust/debris. It is optimal if a boat owner provides coverage of their boat in order to protect their significant investment.

[0004] Accordingly, there is a need for a lightweight stretchable boat cover that can be easily deployed and is compact when not in use so as to facilitate easier storage thereof.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] It is the object of the present invention to provide a boat cover that is configured to be superposed the top of a boat so as to protect the interior thereof wherein the present invention includes a body that is manufactured from a material that has a high stretch percentage.

[0006] Another object of the present invention is to provide a protective cover for a boat that is manufactured from a material having a high stretch percentage wherein a preferred embodiment of the present invention employs a material manufactured with elastane.

[0007] A further object of the present invention is to provide a boat cover that is configured to be superposed the top of a boat so as to protect the interior thereof wherein the body of the present invention is manufactured to provide universal coverage of boats within a certain size range.

[0008] Yet a further object of the present invention is to provide a protective cover for a boat that is manufactured from a material having a high stretch percentage wherein the perimeter of the body of the present invention includes an elastic cord sewn thereinto.

[0009] Still another object of the present invention is to provide a boat cover that is configured to be superposed the top of a boat so as to protect the interior thereof wherein the body of the present invention includes nylon straps and fasteners secured thereto in various locations around the perimeter of the body.

[0010] An additional object of the present invention is to provide a protective cover for a boat that is manufactured from a material having a high stretch percentage wherein the body can be manufactured from blends including but not limited to polyester/elastane blend, nylon/elastane blend and bamboo/elastane blend.

[0011] Yet a further object of the present invention is to provide a boat cover that is configured to be superposed the top of a boat so as to protect the interior thereof wherein the body of the present invention incorporates an integrated zipped pouch for storage thereof.

[0012] To the accomplishment of the above and related objects the present invention may be embodied in the form illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Attention is called to the fact that the drawings are illustrative only. Variations are contemplated as being a part of the present invention, limited only by the scope of the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0013] A more complete understanding of the present invention may be had by reference to the following Detailed Description and appended claims when taken in conjunction with the accompanying Drawings wherein:

[0014] FIG. **1** is a front view of the present invention secured to an exemplary pontoon style boat; and

[0015] FIG. **2** is a side perspective view of the present invention secured to an exemplary pontoon style boat; and

[0016] FIG. **3** is a rear view of the present invention secured to an exemplary ski boat.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0017] Referring now to the drawings submitted herewith, wherein various elements depicted therein are not necessarily drawn to scale and wherein through the views and figures like elements are referenced with identical reference numerals, there is illustrated a boat cover **100** constructed according to the principles of the present invention.

[0018] An embodiment of the present invention is discussed herein with reference to the figures submitted herewith. Those skilled in the art will understand that the detailed description herein with respect to these figures is for explanatory purposes and that it is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that alternative embodiments are plausible. By way of example but not by way of limitation, those having skill in the art in light of the present teachings of the present invention will recognize a plurality of alternate and suitable approaches dependent upon the needs of the particular application to implement the functionality of any given detail described herein, beyond that of the particular implementation choices in the embodiment described herein. Various modifications and embodiments are within the scope of the present invention.

[0019] It is to be further understood that the present invention is not limited to the particular methodology, materials, uses and applications described herein, as these may vary. Furthermore, it is also to be understood that the terminology used herein is used for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only, and is not intended to limit the scope of the present invention. It must be noted that as used herein and in the claims, the singular forms “a”, “an” and “the” include the plural reference unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Thus, for example, a reference to “an element” is a reference to one or more elements and includes equivalents thereof known to those skilled in the art. All conjunctions used are to be understood in the most inclusive sense possible. Thus, the word “or” should be understood as having the definition of a logical “or” rather than that of a logical “exclusive or” unless the context clearly necessitates otherwise. Structures described herein are to be understood also to refer to functional equivalents of such structures. Language that may be construed to express approximation should be so understood unless the context clearly dictates otherwise.

[0020] References to “one embodiment”, “an embodiment”, “exemplary embodiments”, and the like may indicate that the embodiment(s) of the invention so described may include a particular feature, structure or characteristic, but not every embodiment necessarily includes the particular feature, structure or characteristic.

[0021] Referring in particular to the Figures submitted herewith, the boat cover **100** is employed to provide protection of boats from items such as but not limited to dust, debris and sunlight. It should

be understood within the scope of the present invention that the boat cover **100** is provided in alternate sizes and colors. Furthermore, it is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the boat cover **100** can be treated with various chemicals to enhance the UV protection as well as provide water resistance so as to inhibit water from absorbing into the body **10**. It is further contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the body **10** could be provided with a fabric material having alternate thicknesses either across the entire body **10** or in certain portions of the body **10** such as but not limited to rail engagement portions.

[0022] The body **10** in a preferred embodiment is manufactured from a fabric blend that has a stretch percentage of five hundred to eight hundred percent. The stretch percentage in this range provides the ability to manufacture a body **10** that is compact when not in use and as such easier to store in a compartment such as but not limited to under a seat in a boat. The stretch percentage of the body **10** further facilitates a desired tension across the body **10** ensuing installation thereof which provides an engagement with the boat **99** that requires fewer tie down straps **40**. While various fabric blends can be utilized to manufacture the body **10**, in a preferred embodiment the fabric blend employed to manufacture the body **10** is one of the following fabric blends: polyester/elastane blend, nylon/elastane blend and bamboo/elastane blend.

[0023] The body **10** includes perimeter edge **12** wherein the perimeter edge **12** has an elastic cord **14** sewn therein. The elastic cord **14** functions to secure the perimeter edge **12** in areas such as but not limited to underneath the rub rail **98** of a boat **99**. The combination of the stretch percentage of the body **10** and the elastic cord **14** provides a tension force across the body **10** subsequent being moved to its installed position that provides a secure engagement with the boat **99**. The body **10** includes tie-down straps **40** secured thereto in various locations. The tie-down straps **40** are manufactured from a suitable material such as but not limited to nylon. It is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the body **10** could have various quantities of tie-down straps **40** and wherein the tie-down straps **40** could be secured to the body **10** in alternate locations.

[0024] Some embodiments of the body **10** include bow portions **20** wherein the bow portions **20** are configured to extend of an area of the bow of the boat **99**. The bow portions **20** are integrally formed with the body **10** and are generally triangular in shape. The bow portions **20** include tie-down strap **42** wherein the tie-down strap **42** is positioned so as to be tied to a cleat **97** present on the bow of the boat **99**. While not particularly illustrated herein, it is contemplated within the scope of the present invention that the body **10** includes an integrated zippered pouch that is utilized to store the body **10** in its stored position.

[0025] In the preceding detailed description, reference has been made to the accompanying drawings that form a part hereof, and in which are shown by way of illustration specific embodiments in which the invention may be practiced. These embodiments, and certain variants thereof, have been described in sufficient detail to enable those skilled in the art to practice the invention. It is to be understood that other suitable embodiments may be utilized and that logical changes may be made without departing from the spirit or scope of the invention. The description may omit certain information known to those skilled in the art. The preceding detailed description is, therefore, not intended to be limited to the specific forms set forth herein, but on the contrary, it is intended to cover such alternatives, modifications, and equivalents, as can be reasonably included within the spirit and scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A boat cover that is configured to be superposed across a top of a boat to provide protection thereof wherein the boat cover comprises: a body, said body having a perimeter edge, said body being manufactured from a fabric blend having a stretch percentage between five hundred and eight hundred percent, said body being movable between a stored position and a deployed position; a plurality of tie-down straps, said plurality of tie-down straps being secured to said body proximate

said perimeter edge, said plurality of tie-down straps being located in alternate locations around the perimeter edge of the body.

2. The boat cover configured to be superposed across a top of a boat to provide protection thereof as recited in claim 1, wherein the fabric blend is nylon and elastane.

3. The boat cover configured to be superposed across a top of a boat to provide protection thereof as recited in claim 1, wherein the fabric blend is polyester and elastane.

4. The boat cover configured to be superposed across a top of a boat to provide protection thereof as recited in claim 1, wherein the fabric blend is bamboo and elastane.

5. The boat cover configured to be superposed across a top of a boat to provide protection thereof as recited in claim 2, wherein the body further includes a bow portion, said bow portion integrally formed with said body, said bow portion being triangular in shape.

6. The boat cover configured to be superposed across a top of a boat to provide protection thereof as recited in claim 5, wherein said bow portion includes a cleat tie-down strap, said cleat tie-down strap configured to be coupled to a cleat.
